RIDGEPEAK | INDEPENDENT APPLICANT RESEARCH

Deal Execution Playbook

Owner engagement, qualification guide, illustrative nonbinding offer framework, diligence and integration.

AS OF NOVEMBER 4, 2026

Research package 03 | EXECUTION PLAYBOOK

IMPORTANT: This is an independent analyst work sample. It is not affiliated with, authorized by, or prepared for Ridgepeak Partners or Fortress Service Partners. Research candidates are not confirmed sellers. No candidate has been contacted. All private-company financials are unavailable; financial modeling is illustrative only.

Executive operating principle

Full-cycle ownership requires more than generating a target list. This playbook is a simulation of what a junior investment professional would prepare for an authorized sponsor team. No real company has been contacted, no terms have been offered, and no diligence request has been made.

Funnel with disqualifying gates

Stage	Investment professional deliverable	Stop / advance test
1. Research	Source evidence, trade fit, public owner background	Do ownership / service claims reconcile with state records?
2. Qualification	Owner-specific thesis, call preparation and desired next steps	Is owner willing to speak, and is any potential structure aligned?
3. Financial profile	High-level reported revenue, mix, EBITDA, margin normalization	Is there enough verifiable economics to price reasonably?
4. Confidentiality	Mutual NDA, scope of diligence, secure document exchange	Has seller and counsel authorized disclosure?
5. Indicative pricing	Nonbinding LOI with valuation range, rollover and constraints	Does downside return work and is owner aligned?
6. Exclusivity and diligence	QOE, operational, legal, regulatory, insurance and cybersecurity	Are deal-breakers closed or priced?
7. Signing / close	Definitive agreements, approvals, funding and transition plan	Are all conditions met?

Illustrative owner qualification call guide

- Opening: explain who you are and whom you represent truthfully; seek permission to discuss a potential partnership, never imply a firm relationship that does not exist.
- Business: what percentage of activity is maintenance, repairs, replacements, new construction and commercial jobs?
- Workforce: how many technicians and dispatchers, what is average tenure, how many licensed trade supervisors, and how is capacity tracked?
- Customer economics: are there service memberships, what is annual retention and are repeat calls concentrated in specific neighborhoods?
- Owner objectives: what future growth requires support, which elements of the brand must stay local, and how important are liquidity versus retained ownership?
- Next steps: only with consent, request a short profile and agree on an appropriate, confidential follow-up.

Nonbinding LOI framework: SIMULATION, NOT AN OFFER

The following is a framework for counsel and deal leadership, not a real letter to send. Buyer, seller, date, entity, price, equity value, assumed debt, net working capital peg, exclusivity, target close date and operating covenants are all TO BE DETERMINED after diligence. The illustrative workbook is not a basis to quote a live price.

Proposed term category	Example decision framework, not binding terms
Structure	Equity or asset acquisition TBD; scope and tax consequences subject to legal and tax advice.
Consideration	Price requires verified normalized EBITDA, net debt, cash, transaction costs, and an agreed working-capital mechanism.
Rollover	Potential pari passu ownership subject to seller goals, manager equity plan and control rights.
Earnout / seller note	Use only to allocate objectively measurable risks, with clear accounting and dispute provisions.

Proposed term category	Example decision framework, not binding terms
Exclusivity	Negotiated only following alignment and counsel review; no assumption of seller consent.
Conditions	Definitive agreements, confirmatory QOE, financing, licenses, antitrust if applicable, material contracts, management retention.
Binding provisions	Confidentiality, exclusivity and expenses may be binding only when correctly documented by counsel.

Priority diligence checklist, with gating evidence

Priority	Request or analysis	Investment question
Critical	3 years monthly P&L, balance sheets and tax returns	Is reported EBITDA real, normalized and convertible to cash?
Critical	Revenue by service type, cohorts and customer ZIP codes	What fraction is recurring, emergency work, install, new-build, or commercial?
Critical	Employee census, license holders, turnover and compensation	Will the business retain enough qualified technicians after closing?
Critical	Customer reviews, callbacks, warranty liabilities	Is service quality stable and adequately reserved?
High	Job cost and technician profitability data	What is route-level contribution before corporate allocation?
High	Seller compensation, related parties, owner real estate	What normalization and ownership dependencies exist?
High	Truck fleet, equipment and deferred capex	Is reported free cash flow overstated?
High	Maintenance contracts, renewals and churn by cohort	Is repeat revenue durable or merely repetitive one-offs?
High	Permits, licenses, insurance and litigation	Any non-transferable licenses or transaction liabilities?
High	IT stack, dispatch software, payment collection and cybersecurity	Can platform shared services create real value?

First 100 days after close: hypothetical milestones

Days	Operations workplan	Metrics to validate
0-30	Retain local leadership, stabilize technicians, establish KPI baselines, protect brand identity.	Employee retention, customer complaints, calls accepted, completed jobs, cash collection.
31-60	Map dispatch zones and training opportunities; evaluate procurement and fleet savings.	Drive time, calls per tech, parts availability, callback rate, spend per vehicle.
61-100	Test carefully scoped service-agreement offers and customer cross-sell; validate integration ROI.	Renewal conversion, service gross margin, customer acquisition cost, capacity and NPS.

Risk register, owners and escalation criteria

- Seller refuses engagement: do not continue unsolicited contact; move to a different research lead.
- License/insurance gap: stop transaction and request counsel assessment.
- Negative normalized EBITDA adjustments or weak cash conversion: rerun model from verified statements and reprice, or discontinue.
- Technician attrition and owner reliance: require retention plan and downside margin case.
- Exit-multiple dependence: ensure sponsor return meets hurdle on conservative exit assumptions.

Evidence and intended use

All target company details in this package originate from public webpages, primarily company self-descriptions. The state licensing registries are provided as research sources but actual target-level license matching has not been completed. Seller outreach, valuations and offer terms require authorization and independent verification.

Reference documents

https://jobs.ashbyhq.com/ridgepeak-partners/25579d6a-b644-4256-aa29-5e6b8e82b6f3
https://www.fortressservicepartners.com/
https://data.texas.gov/dataset/TDLR-All-Licenses/7358-krk7/data
https://tsbpe.texas.gov/free-licensee-list/